

Image-Text Wrap with CSS Floats

CSS 2.1 §9.5 float block boxes drop out of normal flow and sit at the left or right edge of their containing block. Following inline content wraps around them — the staple of magazine, blog, and brochure layouts before flexbox showed up.



Figure 1 left-floated 140x100

Floats remove themselves from normal flow but still occupy horizontal space, so subsequent lines wrap around them instead of overlapping. A right-side equivalent (`float: right`) pushes content the other way; pair both sides for a true magazine column with imagery on either margin. The `clear` property forces a block to drop past active floats on the

specified side — handy when a section break needs to start with a full-width caption that ignores prior floats.

WebKit's Phase-1 implementation honours the most common subset: `float: left / float: right` with `clear: left / right / both`. Multiple floats stack horizontally until they run out of horizontal room, then drop to a new row. Lines in a paragraph that overlaps a float's vertical extent automatically start past the float and resume at the container edge below it.

With a right float in this section, the body text wraps on the left side. Each line knows its own available width based on whichever floats overlap its vertical range, so a tall float affects only the lines it actually overlaps, not the ones below.

Clearing a block past floats is what

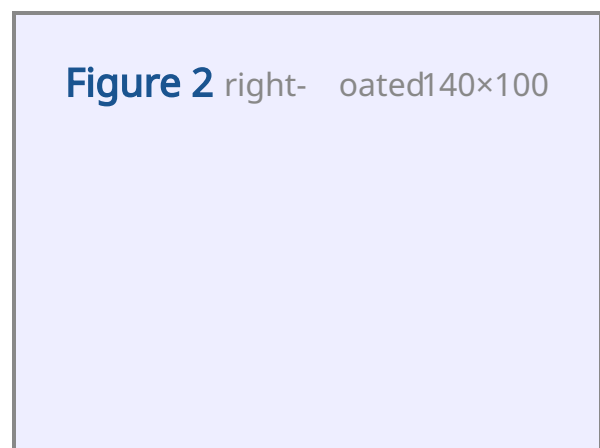


Figure 2 right-floated 140x100

lets headings start flush left or full-width again — try removing the `clear: both` below and watch the next heading slip next to the right instead of starting cleanly below it.

A clean break.

The heading above declares `clear: both`, so it drops past every active float before laying out. Without it, the heading would have started flowing alongside the right-floated caption box and the page rhythm would feel cramped.